



kissan FROM THE FARMER.
SINCE 1934.

L.I.M.E. Season 18

The Next Shelf: Building
the Future of Kissan



Here's What's In It For You!

Live the life of a HUL Brand Manager

Interact with real consumers on a Live Business Challenge

Pre-placement Interview

An opportunity to join us for Unilever Leadership Internship Program 2027

Build your Product Prototype & shoot an Ad

See your idea come to life at our Mumbai Head Office, working with Industry stalwarts.

Win upto ₹16 lakhs

The highest B-school case comp cash Prize
National winner ₹10 lakhs


Hindustan Unilever Limited

LIME
Next-Gen Ideas Meet Real Business Growth SEASON 18

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**PART 1 : THE WORLD'S
PLATE IS CHANGING**

**TASTE JO
CHATT KAR JAO**



PART 1: THE WORLD'S PLATE IS CHANGING

The Global Shift

Every year, the world's largest consumer insight firms — Mintel, Innova Market Insights, Tastewise, and Datassential — track hundreds of thousands of new food launches and consumer surveys to understand where eating habits are heading. A few clear shifts are showing up across their 2026 findings.

1. **Variety is the New Health.** Consumers are moving beyond single-nutrient obsession. Instead, they are looking for diversity in ingredients, flavours and experiences.
2. **Heritage is Becoming Relevant Again.** Traditional formats, preparation techniques and local food cultures are being rediscovered by younger consumers. Brands with authentic roots have a unique advantage.
3. **Flavours Have No Borders.** Consumers are increasingly blending global influences with local tastes. New flavour journeys are emerging through experimentation and cultural exchange.
4. **Experience Matters as Much as Taste.** Texture, mouthfeel and sensory experiences are becoming key drivers of food choice, especially among younger consumers.

Globally, hot and spicy sauces are the fastest-growing sauce category of all, projected to grow at over 8 percent a year, driven mostly by younger consumers chasing bold, global flavours.

CHATORAS



THE CHATORA TRIBE

KISS THE RULES
GOODBYE

PART 1: THE WORLD'S PLATE IS CHANGING

At the same time, India's own condiment culture — chutney, pickle, achaar — is not disappearing. It is being rediscovered by the very same generation that is also experimenting with global flavours. This isn't a contradiction. Consumers do not choose between tradition and discovery. They increasingly want both.

Quick commerce has quietly become the engine behind a lot of this discovery. A consumer can see a food trend on Instagram at 8pm and have a product that fits it delivered to their kitchen by 8.15pm. The gap between craving something and getting it has nearly disappeared.

The Great Indian Kitchen, Today

Today's Indian kitchen is more dynamic than ever.

- Multiple generations often influence food choices.
- Digital content increasingly inspires cooking behavior.
- Regional cuisines are becoming sources of pride.
- Consumers are experimenting more frequently with flavors and formats.
- Product discovery begins online before it happens in-store.

The market is being served by two distinct types of players:

1. **Legacy Brands** — Trusted, familiar and widely available, but often slower to innovate, and often built around one hero category rather than a full kitchen repertoire.
2. **Challenger Brands** — Fast-moving, culturally relevant and experimental, increasingly showing up as a Masterbrand across an entire shelf of sauces, dips and dressings, not just one product.

The opportunity lies between these two worlds.

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DOUBLE DIP IS FINE!

DUNK FIRST ASK LATER

CHAOS & CHUTNEY



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PART 2 : THE BRAND AT THE CENTRE OF THIS CASE

TASTE JO
CHATT KAR JAO



PART 2: THE BRAND AT THE CENTRE OF THIS CASE

Kissan has been part of Indian kitchens for over ninety years. Today, it is India's No. 1 ketchup brand and India's No. 1 jams and preserves brand by retail value, alongside a portfolio that also includes squash and peanut butter. It built this position the hard way, by being the sauce every household trusts and the jam every child grew up on.

For most of its history, that trust sat on familiar ground: ketchup, jam, squash, peanut butter.

Why This Case Exists Now?

Here is the uncomfortable part. A brand can be the market leader in its category and still be losing ground, because the game has stopped being about who wins ketchup or who wins jam. It has become about who owns the shelf.

A new generation of challenger brands, Veeba and Ching's among them, has not tried to out-ketchup Kissan. Instead, they have built themselves as Masterbrands: one name spanning sauces, ketchups, mayonnaise, dips and dressings, so that a consumer who trusts them for one product is invited to trust them for the next ten. Kissan, by contrast, has largely been known for two things: ketchup and jam. That is a strong position to defend, but a narrow one to grow from, especially as Kissan's own brand power has started to soften even within its core categories.

This raises the obvious question, and it is one this case wants you to sit with before you design anything: **Why doesn't Kissan simply reinvent its existing categories?** Make the ketchup more exciting, relaunch the jam, sharpen the packaging, and call it a day?



PART 2: THE BRAND AT THE CENTRE OF THIS CASE

Why Kissan Can Win?

Kissan's next chapter is not about changing what the brand stands for, but about making it more relevant for a new consumer generation. This starts with refreshing its proposition and pack design across the current portfolio to deliver a more modern, contemporary expression of the brand. Beyond the core range, Kissan has the opportunity to extend its authority in packaged foods into categories such as chutneys and other untapped white spaces, driving growth while staying rooted in its trusted heritage.

Kissan brings three powerful advantages:

1. **Scale.** A distribution network reaching millions of consumers across modern trade, general trade and emerging channels.
2. **Trust.** Deep household penetration built over decades.
3. **Credibility.** Strong equity rooted in quality ingredients and relationships with Indian agriculture.

However, success will require solving a critical challenge: How can Kissan create relevance for a new generation, and credibly compete with Masterbrand challengers, while strengthening the trust that has made it successful?

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PART 3 : THE CASE

TASTE JO
CHATT KAR JAO



Your Mandate

Identify Kissan's next growth opportunity and build a compelling product mix around it:

- a genuine **new product idea** for the brand,
- backed by **real consumer insighting**.
- Approach like a **HUL Brand Manager** : define the opportunity, shape the product proposition, and build a winning go-to-market plan for how people will discover it, all before anyone even gets to the advertising.



TASK 1: DISCOVER THE CONSUMER

This is the part of the case we're most excited for you to do, and the part that will make or break your idea. Don't run a Google Form. Immerse yourself in real consumer contexts. Observe how people cook, eat, shop, and make food choices. Speak to 20 people, across at least two generations if you can, and ideally across more than one city tier. Sit with them while they cook, if they'll let you. Open a fridge with permission and ask what's inside and why. Move beyond stated behaviour and uncover underlying motivations.

Explore:-

1. What drives experimentation?
2. What food rituals are non-negotiable?
3. Where are consumers seeking convenience?
4. What flavours or experiences are missing today?
5. How are consumers discovering new food brands and products, and what actually gets them to try one for the first time?
6. When consumers think of a brand as "new" or "exciting" versus "old" or "safe," what is it about how that brand looks, sounds, or shows up that gives them that feeling?



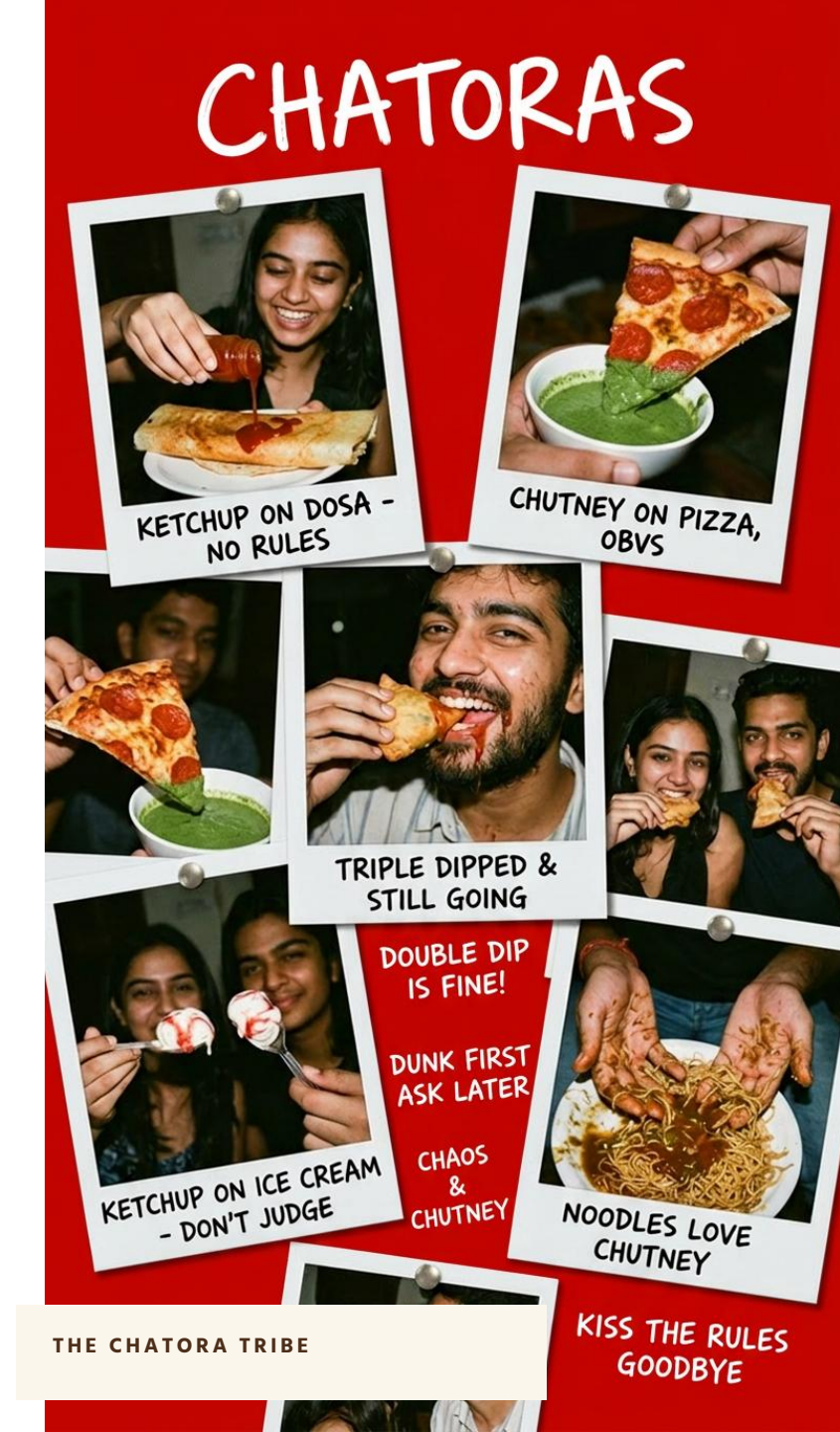
TASK 2: DEFINE THE OPPORTUNITY

Bring these together into one slide covering:-

- The white space you've identified, and why it exists in Indian kitchens right now (not two years ago, not two years from now).
- Why Kissan is uniquely positioned to win in this space, and how it's different from simply making the existing ketchup or jam business better.
- Your Big Idea, in one line.
- The consumer insight underneath it, framed as something the consumer already believes or feels, that your idea directly speaks to.

Use your research to identify a clear white space for Kissan. The opportunity should:-

- Address a genuine consumer need
- Be relevant today
- Be difficult for competitors to replicate
- Leverage Kissan's strengths
- Extend beyond line extensions or incremental variants



TASK 3: BUILD IT OUT

Translate your idea into a real business proposition. This is where a good idea either becomes a real, launchable product, or falls apart under its own weight. Be specific wherever you can; vague answers are the easiest thing for a jury to spot.

PRODUCT — What exactly is it? Format, flavour, core ingredients, and what makes it genuinely different from what's already on the shelf.

PACKAGING — What should the pack look and feel like? What's the one visual cue that says new Kissan, not old Kissan?

PROPOSITION — Beyond this one product, what does it say about how Kissan should look, sound and behave differently from how it does today? At what price, and why, for this consumer, at this occasion?

PRICE – What is your pricing logic?



WHAT YOU NEED TO SUBMIT?

1. A **60sec elevator** pitch video submission
2. **Two supporting slides** that covers the three tasks :
 - Slide 1: Consumer Job : Who is your TG? & What are you trying to solve?
 - Slide 2: Concept Card : Your big Idea

Template for the slides are at the end of this deck



IF YOU MAKE THE TOP 5

If your idea is shortlisted among the Top 5 teams on your campus, you'll be asked to go one level deeper: build the full business case for your idea and pitch it live to the HUL jury, the same way a brand team would pitch a new launch to leadership for sign-off.

You don't need to prepare that yet. Get the idea right first.



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Slide Template

TASTE JO
CHATT KAR JAO



Slide 1 : Consumer Job

**Define your
consumer
persona**

**Identify the
opportunity**

When I....

I want to...

So that...

Slide 2: Concept Card (Consumer Pitch)

1. Compelling Functional and Emotional Benefits

2. ...Built on an Insight Inside...

No insight statement explicitly written!

3. Using Bold, Creative Language...

4. ...As crisp copy that lands...

NO MORE THAN 80 WORDS!

5. ...with an Impactful, Bold image.

(could be pack, could be talent)

***Please note this will be shared with consumers for feedback so please keep it simple & clean**

Consumer Job Sample

Solo Levellers

Food excitement outside is on fire but not inside the kitchen

"I'm **slowly** trying new recipes from YouTube or Instagram reels, I'm mostly experimental, not following recipes exactly."



Abhishek, 26 yrs, LSM 9



I WANT TO FEED MY
CHILDREN
HEALTHY FOOD

When I come home tired from work in the middle of the week,

I want to have a quick way of making healthy food

So that I don't feel that being a working mother is compromising my children's health

Concept Card SAMPLE

NEW

GRAY CONCEALER

3IN1 SHAMPOO + CONDITIONER + COLOR BUILD UP

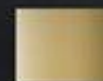
GRADUALLY FUSES GRAYS
WITH NATURAL HAIR COLOR

DAILY USE RECOMMENDED FOR
GRADUAL RESULTS WITHIN A WEEK

FOR STRONGER LOOKING HAIR IN 1 SIMPLE STEP



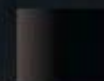
AVAILABLE IN
3 SHADES



BLONDE



BROWN



DARK



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All the Best!